



FOUR WEEKS, FOUR DIFFERENT GAMES

Play the rule, not the season

Each challenge scores differently and caps your squad differently. The winning shape in one week is the losing shape in the next.

GW2

Welcome Back

Promoted clubs double · up to 3 per club

One fixture decides it — the only promoted-v-promoted game.

GW3

All Out Attack

Goals & assists double · one per club

Defenders are close to worthless. Eleven clubs, all attackers.

GW4

Derby Day

Man Utd & Man City double · up to 3 per club

Both sides of one match — a hedge and an anti-correlation at once.

GW5

The Shield

Defensive contributions score 10 · one per club

A defender clearing the threshold outscores a goalscorer.

RISK

Squad size, budget, formation and whether transfers carry are NOT stated on the Challenge tiles. These are shapes and priority orders, not a locked XI.

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WELCOME BACK

Back the one soft fixture

Promoted-club players score **double**. Up to three per club.

Coventry v Hull is the only promoted-versus-promoted fixture in the round — the only one where doubled points are not asked to survive a Premier League defence.

01

Carl Rushworth

GK · Coventry

17 clean sheets

A doubled clean sheet is the highest-**probability** doubled event on the board, and it is at home to the other promoted side.

02

Milan van Ewijk

DEF · Coventry

set pieces

Attacking right-back — doubles on the clean sheet **and** on an assist.

03

Haji Wright

FWD · Coventry

penalties

Main striker and penalty taker. A doubled penalty is the cleanest 8 points available.

AVOID

Ipswich, away at Old Trafford. Double points on a blank is a blank.

RISK

An outside model ranks Coventry's defence 19th of 20. Three Coventry players is a concentrated bet on one match.

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ALL OUT ATTACK

Eleven clubs, all attackers

Goals and assists score **double**. Clean sheets and DefCon do not. One player per club.

The one week where defenders are close to worthless and the whole budget belongs to attackers in soft fixtures.

01

Erling Haaland
Man City – home to Coventry

penalties

The softest attacking fixture in the round, and he takes the penalties.

02

Bruno Fernandes
Man Utd – away at Everton

pens

FKs

corners

Our register calls his set-piece monopoly the standout asset in that squad. Every route to a doubled assist runs through him.

03

A Liverpool attacker
away at Ipswich

2nd-softest

Which asset is a live-price question this build cannot answer offline.

04

An Aston Villa attacker
away at Hull

3rd-softest

Same reasoning, one rung down.

AVOID

Arsenal v Chelsea. Two strong defences cancelling is the wrong shape for a week that only pays goals and assists.

RISK

One player per club means no stacking a soft fixture — the constraint, not the player pool, is what shapes this XI.

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DERBY DAY

Four doubled, not six

Manchester United and Manchester City players score **double**. Up to three per club.

Doubling both sides of one match is a hedge and an anti-correlation at once: half the block is always on the right side, but a clean sheet for one is a blank for the other.

01

Erling Haaland
Man City

doubledpenalties

Doubled, and the penalty taker.

02

Bruno Fernandes
Man Utd

doubledtakes everything

Penalties, direct free kicks and corners.

03

Mbeumo or Cunha
Man Utd

mid-price

Our register rates both as strong returns behind Bruno.

04

Cherki
Man City

FKscorners

High assists, and the creator role in a rebuilt side.

AVOID

Doubled defenders from this fixture — the two defences cancel. Six doubled players riding one ninety minutes is variance, not edge.

RISK

This rests on an INFERENCE that GW4 contains the Manchester derby. Our register does not hold that fixture; it was narrowed to two possibilities and settled by the challenge tile naming exactly those two clubs. If it is wrong, this card is wrong.

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THE SHIELD

Pick the fixture, then the player

Defensive contributions score **10** instead of 2. One player per club.

An opponent table beats a hit rate: what matters is how much defending the fixture actually asks for.

01

Muharemović
DEF · Leeds — v Crystal Palace
53% 10.7/start opp 62%
Palace is the single highest row in the opponent table.

02

João Gomes
MID · Aston Villa — at Spurs
47% 11.7/start opp 39%
Tottenham tops the central-midfield table.

03

Vušković
DEF · Brighton — v Arsenal
63% 12.4/start opp 44%
Highest per-start figure in the entire £5.0m bracket.

04

Lacroix
DEF · Chelsea — at Brentford
60% 10.7/start opp 43%
Consistent hitter in a fixture that supplies the work.

05

Ballard
DEF · Sunderland — at Man City
54% opp 38%
A Sunderland defender at the Etihad will not be short of defending to do.

Avoid

Man Utd defenders at Fulham — the lowest row in the table at 23%, so the fixture suppresses the very thing scoring 10. And all Man City players: they will dominate the ball, so their own defenders do nothing.

RISK

Elliot Anderson is NOT here despite a 70% hit rate — that was earned at Forest and our register has him at Man City now.

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WHAT IS ACTUALLY BEING BET ON

Where this could be wrong

Every pick in this set is a priority under stated assumptions. None of it is a prediction that anything will happen.

- 01

Minutes risk dominates
Three of the five Shield picks changed club this summer. A DefCon rate is worthless if the player does not start.
- 02

No Premier League basis
Vušković's 63% is Bundesliga, Muharemović's 53% is Serie A. Neither has a Premier League minute — and our own app now refuses to print a hit rate for players in that position.
- 03

Last season, other managers
Eight of seventeen opponent rows are marked as clubs that changed manager — including Crystal Palace, the row the top Shield pick leans hardest on.
- 04

GW4 is an inference
The Manchester derby is derived, not held. It settles the moment the fixture list is read.
- 05

The app does not model this
No per-gameweek scoring overrides, no per-club constraint solver. These picks were assembled by hand.